

Jessica Alba Dynasty League – 2022 Proposed League Changes

I. Introduction

Greetings to you good gentlemen. We've another season on the books and there's no off-season in this league so it's onto the next.

Ahead of our meeting at some time in February, I'd like to propose some changes to the league to help keep things progressing. We can discuss these in full at the meeting but helpful for everyone to think about ahead of time and if you can't make it to let your thoughts be known.

If anyone has any other suggested changes, please let me know.

II. Proposed Changes

There are two primary changes I want to propose:

- Extending the taxi for sophomores and adding two additional taxi spots to compensate
- An additional flex spot

Taxi Extension and Addition

I think it's safe to say all of our rookie picks from our first rookie draft didn't exactly pan out. Some didn't make a roster, some were injured in the pre-season, some injured in-season, some stuck behind a veteran and some plain not good enough for the NFL.

The rookies who are in positions where they were backup to an established veteran are the ones I am most interesting in highlighting for the purpose of extending the taxi. The Tray Lances, Jordan Loves and Noah Grays of this world don't really suit our taxi as it stands. Jordan Love will be in his third year stuck behind Rodgers, Lance his second behind Jimmy G and Noah Gray his second behind Travis Kelce. At some point these players, particularly the ever-valuable QBs will make their mark but these positions can take time and experience to develop into established starters and reliable fantasy assets. This can be true for some receivers too but rarely for RBs (outside injuries).

To account for these limited but potentially very valuable players I propose that a Rookie drafted by their owner, picked up in the free agency auction, on waivers or traded for before the taxi cut off in the previous season may stay on the taxi for a second year. The taxi will not be available for any other sophomores. While Sleeper won't allow this to be the rule it app we can manage it ourselves. I'll take a

screen shot of the taxi squads immediately prior to the rookie draft. It will only be these players eligible to remain on the same taxi for a second year.

I don't want this change to impinge upon a GMs draft so I am suggesting we extend the taxi to seven spots. This will allow a GM to have their standard five draft picks and keep two players for one more year. Alternatively, they could draft four and keep three and put one on their bench or any other combination within the overall limit of seven.

Additional Flex Spot

Our large rosters mean that pretty much every valuable asset is either sitting in our rosters or on our taxis scoring points but not contributing to our teams. We've all got more than enough players to account for an additional starting spot. I don't suggest that this be a superflex spot, QBs are scarce enough as it is, but an additional RB/WR/TE Flex could allow for different roster constructions within our existing rosters.

I don't intend that this be introduced immediately but to start in 2024. This gives three rookie drafts and off seasons to prepare for the change (and hopefully an end to all this Covid nonsense which could cause an issue with an additional spot now).

Other Areas of Discussion

Prize Structure

Are we happy with the £20 annual subs and prizes? Should we be paying for other achievements in the year, i.e. top weekly points scorer, most efficient manager?

Collusion Rules

At the moment we have no rules about collusion other than that the Commissioner can intervene in trades if they suspect collusion. One issue that's been raised several times is around the question of 'loaning' players. This is collusion. We could mitigate against this by introducing a simple rule that the same players cannot be traded between two teams within a specified period of time.

Return from IR

There were some grumbings this year around the period of time players remained on IR when no longer eligible. The 3-day rule is set so that when a player returns from IR late on Sunday or on a Monday, GMs would be forced to drop players eligible for the Tuesday game only, this could include starters as the only eligible players to drop. Forcing a GM to drop a starter on the basis of a technicality

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of a returning bench player from IR would be against the underlying principle of fair play and maintaining competitiveness in the league.

A complication this year in particular is that a lot of players, particularly towards the end of the season, were dropping in and out of COVID IR regularly. This created an unusual situation and exacerbated the perception that GMs were not playing within the spirit of the rules.

I do not intend to propose any changes at this point but GMs are reminded that they should attempt, wherever possible, to ensure that there are no active players on their IR. Repeat offenders without cause for not making a change earlier (for example a return of a player from IR on a Friday or Saturday while the vast majority of their roster is still available to drop) may be subject to a 10 point penalty in that game week.

Trade Deadline

Are we happy with the trade deadline being the Sunday prior to the Championship week? Do we want to move it forward to before the playoffs start? Or we could ditch it completely? There was significantly less deadline action this year than last....

Kickers

Ditch them from 2024?

iii. **2022 Rookie Draft**

We tried to sort a date close to the NFL draft but ended up moving later and later in the year. So, here's a few options to discuss:

1. We draft when we are all available on a Friday/Saturday. Looking at dates from 24th June on.
Pro – we can all get together, potentially some in person!
Con – 2 months after the NFL draft and not really keeping in spirit of the league
2. Draft on 13th May without Alex (if we're all available)
Pro – we can mostly draft together and some in person and two weeks out from the NFL draft.
Con – one absentee drafter
3. Draft on a weekday in May
Pro – Draft closer to the NFL Draft
Con – More limited opportunity to meet in person

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4. Draft the first 3 rounds on 13th May then slow draft the remaining 2 rounds
Pro – all those with draft picks (as it stands) are together to draft, potentially in person. Draft close to the NFL draft and it's only really the first three rounds that matter.
Con – Effectively excludes the opportunity for Alex to buy his way into the draft.
5. From 13th May, slow draft the whole thing
Pro – Draft closer to the NFL draft, more likelihood of picks being traded.
Con – Any get together would be purely social (ok not really a con) but removes the live draft element which is part of the fun.

We always have the free agent auction in August to get together for an in-person draft later in the summer.....if we can agree on a date!

iv. 2022 Season Fixtures – Divisions

After two years and 27 matchups we have all played each other 3 times each. With 14 regular season games (at the moment) we now have 5 matchups each year where we would play an additional team twice. To ensure fairness I have developed two five-team divisions to determine who we play against in those additional games.

The first 9 games of the season will be matchups against every team in the league. From weeks 10 to 14 you will play each divisional rival once and one team from the other division.

The divisions consists of:

Wait for it.....

Alpha	Beta
Alex	Chris
Dave	Gareth
Jebus	Lee
Mike	Neil
Ross	Rich

The split of teams into divisions was decided on the basis of three factors from the combined data of the last two seasons. These factors were: Record, Maximum Points For and Final Finish. The divisions will be reviewed every three years to ensure continued parity in fixtures. Open to suggestions for division names.

Fixtures will be announced in May at the same time as the NFL fixtures are announced.